ZEAL COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING & RESEARCH, PUNE
PRESENTS

ALGOBID

Offical Event Rulebook

AVISHKAR '26
WHERE CURIOSITY BECOMES CREATION

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1. **Event Overview**

- Event Name & Tagline: AlgoBid: The Algorithmic Auction, with the tagline "Bid Smart. Code Faster. Win Bigger."
- Event Description: This is a high-energy, strategy-driven competitive programming event that combines the thrill of live auctions with algorithmic problem-solving. Teams use a starting budget of $1000 Virtual Money (VM) to bid in real-time to acquire coding problems.
- Event Format at a Glance: The event consists of 2 rounds, each structured as an Auction + Solve format with a 90-minute duration.
- Phases: Auction Phase (20 minutes) and Solving Phase (70 minutes).
- Scoring: Points are earned by solving won problems, and there is a hint system that deducts 200 points per hint used (maximum 2 per problem).

5. **Problem & Points Structure**

- Problem Categories: Problems are categorized by difficulty and base points:
- P1 (Easy): 1000 pts (Standard logic/array problems)
- P2 (Medium): 1500 pts (Sorting, searching, basic DP)
- P3 (Hard): 2000 pts (Graphs, advanced DP, complex logic)
- P4 (Medium/Hard Mix): 1500 - 1800 pts (Varies per round)
- Scoring Formula: Final Score = Sum of (Points from solved problems) - (200 x Hints used per problem). Note that unsolved problems yield 0 points, and the bid amount spent is non-refundable regardless of the outcome.

3. Official Rulebook

3.1 Auction Rules:
Every team MUST bid on every problem.
Minimum bid increment is $50 VM per raise.
Teams are limited to bidding only their current available Virtual Money.
Highest bidder wins the problem, and in case of a tie, the team that placed the bid fastest wins.
Each team can win at most ONE problem per round, and all bids are final.

3.2 Solving Rules: Only the winning team may attempt to solve the problem. Submissions must be made through the designated platform (e.g., HackerRank / LeetCode custom judge). Scoring is binary (full points for correct, zero for incorrect), and no partial credit is awarded. All code must be written during the event window.

3.3 Hint System: Teams may request up to 2 hints per problem. Each hint deducts 200 points from the final score, and requests must be made in writing to the invigilator.

- 3.4 Round 2 Special Rules: Round 2 may involve adjusted problem difficulty and point values, or use unsolved problems from Round 1. The bidding time is reduced in Round 2 to increase pressure.
- 3.5 Disqualification Criteria: Teams will be auto-disqualified for:
- Use of the internet outside the designated judge platform.
- Inter-team communication, collaboration, or code similarity.
- Submitting pre-written or plagiarized solutions.
- Attempting to view another team's problem set or engaging in disruptive behavior.
- 3.6 Tiebreaker Rules: Ties are broken first by the earliest correct submission timestamp, then by the team with fewer hints used, and finally by judge discretion.

4. **System Requirements**

- Computer Lab Specifications (Minimum): Requires a minimum of an Intel Core i3 (8th Gen) / Ryzen 3 processor, 4 GB RAM, and OS Windows 10 / Ubuntu 20.04. Recommended to have a 15-inch, 1080p screen.

- Software Requirements: VS Code (pre-installed) or any available IDE is required. Supported languages include C++, Python 3.x, and Java 11+. Access is limited to a whitelisted judge platform (HackerRank / Codeforces / LeetCode Custom Judge).

- Network & Security: Systems must be connected to an event intranet, with Internet access restricted to the judge platform URL only. Screen recording or invigilator monitoring must be active, and USB ports disabled on all participant machines.

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5. **Team & Participation Structure**

- Team Composition: Teams must consist of 3 to 4 members.
- Teams per Batch: Limited to 5 to 6 teams maximum per batch.
- Why Limit to 5-6 Teams per Batch?: The limit is necessary because each round has a limited number of problems, ensuring that teams have a problem to solve. It also helps ensure focused monitoring and tighter competition

6. **Why AlgoBid? — Conclusion**

- For Participants: The event tests both algorithmic thinking and economic decision-making. It creates pressure and rewards teams that are strategic and disciplined, rather than just the best coders.

- For Organizers & Institutions: The format is unique and intellectually rich, encouraging participation across different difficulty bands. It naturally balances competition and creates high audience engagement.

- The Bottom Line: The event rewards "clarity of thought over chaos," and the winner is the "best thinker".

7. **Prizes:**

- **First Prize: 4,000/-**
- **Second Prize: 3,000/-**
- **Third Prize: 2,000/-**